DETECT THE DWELLERS · CHAPTER DICE TEST

A paper test of one idea: **match symbols instead of adding numbers.** Play it, then play today's Quick Shift with the same group, and compare (see *docs/PLAYTEST.md*). Best with **2 players**: solo and 4 players aren't tuned yet.

YOU NEED

This sheet's cards and dice stickers. Seven blank d6s (16 mm) with the stickers on. The amber d20 for the persistence row. Coins: 2 per player for HP, about 20 to cover symbols.

SETUP

1. Each player picks an analyst and takes that analyst's die. Start at **29 HP**.
2. Shuffle the six mobs face down. The Lockjaw Syndicate goes underneath.
3. Shuffle the 8 agent cards: that's the kit deck. The crew starts with 2 agents (1 solo).

THE SYMBOLS

Detect · **Contain** · **Eradicate**. A mob's row of symbols is its hits. Cover a symbol with a coin when you remove it. Bigger crews add the symbols printed for 3 and 4 players.

A FLIP

1. Pick who's on point.
2. Flip the top mob. If anything is on the row, roll the amber d20: every row mob whose range includes the roll comes back with all its symbols. The two with the highest Damage hit everyone on the way in.
3. Fight. When the feed is empty, the boss arrives with one last row roll and no arrival hits.

A FIGHT ROUND

1. **Row.** From the second round on, roll the row first.
2. **Roll.** Everyone rolls their die. On point rolls theirs a second time. Solo: roll yours twice, plus the crew die. Each running Triage Agent rolls the agent die.
3. **Match.** A face removes one matching symbol from a mob. A **double face** removes two of that symbol from one mob, **or guards**: you block this round. Not both.
4. **Hits back.** Every mob still up hits everyone who isn't blocking, for its Damage.

Agent dice can't hit the boss, and can't guard.

AFTER A FIGHT

Beaten mobs go on the row, unless they already came back once: then they're gone for good. Draw 2 agent cards (1 solo) into the tray, which holds 5. Run an agent every round, or burn it once for its big effect.

WIN OR LOSE

Beat the boss and you've survived the night. Anyone at 0 HP and the shift is lost.

KEYWORDS IN THIS TEST

Beacon: roll the row when it arrives. **Piercing:** blocks don't stop it. **Targeted:** only on point takes its damage, doubled. **Evasive:** only a double face can hit it. **Regen:** gets one symbol back at the end of each round. **Escalating:** +1 Damage every round it stays up.

Prototype only. Numbers from the bot sim of 2026-10-30 (prototypes/chapter-dice/README.md). Record: who played, time, win or loss, and every rule you played wrong.

DICE STICKERS

Print at 100% on sticker paper. Cut on the grey lines. Each row is one die: put its six faces on a blank 16 mm d6. Double faces show the symbol twice.

Hunter



Responder



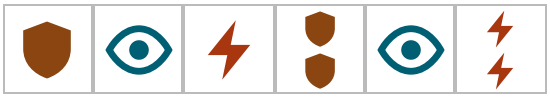
Engineer



Soarcerer



Fixer



Crew die (solo's third die)



Agent die (Triage)



Spare set for on point's second roll, if you'd rather roll two dice than one twice:

Hunter (spare)



Responder (spare)



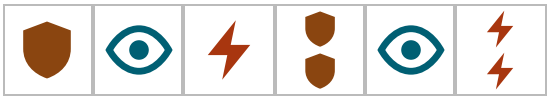
Engineer (spare)



Soarcerer (spare)



Fixer (spare)



IDENTITY · BACK ON 1–13

MAILER DAEMON

DAMAGE 1



3 players add · 4 players add

Beacon. Roll the row when it arrives or comes back.

MAILER-DAEMON says your message bounced. Click here to retry. You never sent one.

IDENTITY · BACK ON 1–13

PASSWORD SPRAYER

DAMAGE 1



3 players add · 4 players add

Piercing. Blocks don't stop it.

Summer2026! tries every account in the tower, one a minute. It only needs one to work.

CLOUD · BACK ON 1–9

OAUTH CONSENT GRIFTER

DAMAGE 3



3 players add · 4 players add

Targeted. Only on point takes its damage, doubled.

A friendly pop-up asks if this app may read all your mail. Someone's thumb is already on Accept.

ENDPOINT · BACK ON 1–11

LIVING-OFF-THE-LAND SCAVENGER

DAMAGE 3



3 players add · 4 players add

Evasive. Only a double face can hit it.

Rundll32, mshta, certutil: every tool it runs is yours. It lives off what already grows here.

NETWORK · BACK ON 1–8

EXFIL COURIER

DAMAGE 4



3 players add · 4 players add

Escalating. +1 Damage every round it stays up.

rclone.exe is moving 40 GB to a cloud bucket you've never seen. It's still small. For now.

ENDPOINT · BACK ON 1–8

ROOTKIT IMPLANT

DAMAGE 4



3 players add · 4 players add

Regen. Gets one symbol back at the end of each round.

You count the svchost.exe processes twice. One looks exactly right, and it has teeth.

BOSS · ARRIVES AT 05:59

THE LOCKJAW SYNDICATE

DAMAGE 9



3 players add · 4 players add

Double extortion. +2 Damage until it has lost two symbols. Agent dice can't hit it.

REFERENCE

DICE

Crew die (solo's third die)



Agent die (Triage)



A double face: two of that symbol from one mob, **or** guard. Never both.

ANALYST · YOUR DIE

HUNTER



Any face you roll is wild against a mob that came back from the row. A comeback you finish is gone for good.

ANALYST · YOUR DIE

RESPONDER



Your Contain faces are wild against the highest-Damage mob, boss included.

ANALYST · YOUR DIE

ENGINEER



Your die has three double faces: hit twice or guard, more often.

ANALYST · YOUR DIE

SOARCERER



The tray holds one more agent (6). Every won fight draws one more agent card.

ANALYST · YOUR DIE

FIXER



After every fight, heal 5 HP split across the crew. Recovery Agents heal 3 more.

AGENT

TRIAGE AGENT

RUN IT
Rolls the agent die every round.

OR BURN IT
On point rolls their die 3 more times this round.

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RUN IT
Rolls the agent die every round.

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On point rolls their die 3 more times this round.

AGENT

ENRICHMENT AGENT

RUN IT
Once a round, turn one crew die to any symbol.

OR BURN IT
Every die is wild this round.

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ENRICHMENT AGENT

RUN IT
Once a round, turn one crew die to any symbol.

OR BURN IT
Every die is wild this round.

AGENT

CONTAINMENT AGENT

RUN IT
The highest-Damage mob deals 2 less, never below 1.

OR BURN IT
Remove one symbol from every mob (the boss keeps at least one).

AGENT

CONTAINMENT AGENT

RUN IT
The highest-Damage mob deals 2 less, never below 1.

OR BURN IT
Remove one symbol from every mob (the boss keeps at least one).

AGENT

RECOVERY AGENT

RUN IT
After every fight, heal 4 HP split across the crew.

OR BURN IT
Heal 6 HP split across the crew.

AGENT

RECOVERY AGENT

RUN IT
After every fight, heal 4 HP split across the crew.

OR BURN IT
Heal 6 HP split across the crew.